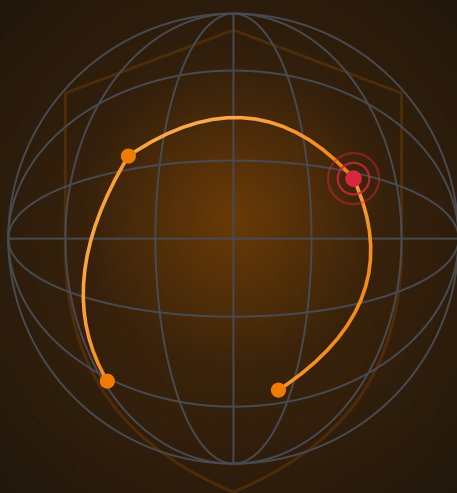




THREAT PULSE

WEEKLY CYBER THREAT BRIEFING

WEEK IN REVIEW · 14–20 SEPTEMBER 2026

Inside this week: an **actively-exploited flaw in Google Pixel phones** linked to spyware, a **critical business-server bug** under thousands of attacks, and a **poisoned software supplier** that leaked 170 private code stores — explained in plain English, with the practical steps that matter.

Welcome to **Threat Pulse**, your plain-English weekly round-up of the cyber threats making waves around the world — and what they mean for your business. This week the standout story is close to home: a flaw in **Google Pixel phones** that is already being used in real, targeted spyware attacks — a reminder that the device in your pocket needs the same care as your servers. No jargon, just what happened and the practical steps worth taking.

AT A GLANCE THIS WEEK

 **8.8** /10

Severity of the Google Pixel phone flaw now under active, targeted attack

 **7,000**

Attacks in a week against a critical business-server flaw (Orkes Conductor)

 **170**

Private code stores stolen via one poisoned software supplier

THIS WEEK'S HEADLINE THREAT

GOOGLE PIXEL (ANDROID) • CVE-2026-58704

A Google Pixel phone flaw is being used in real, targeted spyware attacks



Exploitation: **limited & targeted**

WHAT'S HAPPENING

A weakness in the **cellular modem** of Google Pixel phones — the chip that connects the phone to the mobile network — lets an attacker who is **close by, on the same or a nearby network**, quietly gain extra control of the device. Google says there are signs it is **already being used in limited, targeted attacks**, and the pattern matches the commercial “spyware” used to snoop on specific individuals. Google shipped the fix in its **September security update**.

WHO'S AFFECTED

Anyone using a **Google Pixel phone** that has not yet installed the **September 2026 update** (security patch level 5 September 2026 or later). Other Android brands (Samsung and the rest) and Apple iPhones are **not** affected by this particular flaw. The US cyber agency CISA has added it to its list of vulnerabilities **known to be exploited**.

WHY IT MATTERS TO YOU

A compromised phone can expose **calls, messages, location and the accounts you sign into from it** — a serious risk for executives, finance staff and anyone who handles sensitive information on a mobile.

Good news: the fix is already out — a two-minute update closes it. The attacks seen so far have been **limited and aimed at specific individuals**, not mass campaigns, and phones from other brands are not affected by this flaw.

What to do about the headline threat

-  Update every **Google Pixel phone** now: **Settings > Security & privacy > System & updates**, and check the security patch level shows **5 September 2026 or later**.
-  Turn on **automatic updates** for all company and staff mobile devices so future fixes install themselves.
-  Update **higher-risk staff first** (executives, finance, anyone handling sensitive data) — and remind everyone that phones need patching just like laptops.

OTHER THREATS WORTH KNOWING ABOUT



HIGH

A critical business-server flaw is under thousands of attacks

Attackers are hammering **Orkes Conductor**, a tool many firms use to automate back-office workflows. A serious bug (CVE-2026-58138) lets them run their own commands on the server **without any password**; security vendors logged **~7,000 attempts in a single week**. A fixed version (3.30.2) is available.

Takeaway: patch internet-facing business software promptly, and keep admin panels and APIs off the public internet.



HIGH

A hidden “master key” found in popular IT software

A flaw in **SolarWinds Access Rights Manager** (CVE-2026-28326) — software many IT teams use to manage who can access what — contained a **built-in, hard-coded key** that could let an attacker take over the system remotely. It is **not yet being exploited**, and a fix (version 2026.2.1) is out.

Takeaway: apply the update quickly — hard-coded-key flaws are easy for attackers to reuse once details are public.



MEDIUM

A poisoned software “ingredient” leaked 170 private code stores

Attackers slipped malicious code into a widely-used free software component (part of the popular **TanStack** toolkit). It quietly stole login credentials — and at security firm **CrowdSec** that let attackers copy **170 private code repositories**. A stark example of risk arriving through the software supply chain.

Takeaway: know which outside code and suppliers your systems depend on, and rotate developer and cloud access keys regularly.

★ **Your 3-minute checklist this week**

- ✓ Update all **Google Pixel phones** to the September patch (5 Sep 2026 or later) and switch on **automatic mobile updates**.
- ✓ Ask your IT team to patch **internet-facing business software** (e.g. Orkes Conductor, SolarWinds ARM) and take admin panels off the public internet.
- ✓ If you share code or cloud accounts with developers or suppliers, **rotate access keys and tokens**.
- ✓ Remind staff to **pause and verify** any unexpected request for money, log-ins or data.

Threat Pulse is provided by DPG-Cyber for general awareness only and does not constitute specific security or legal advice. Threat details are drawn from reputable public reporting as at 21 September 2026 and may evolve as investigations continue. For guidance tailored to your environment, please contact your DPG-Cyber account team.

BEHIND THE HEADLINES

Why a **watchful eye** changes the outcome

Every threat in this issue had one thing in common: the damage happened in the **quiet gap between the break-in and the moment someone noticed**. Tools alone rarely stop an attack — what limits the harm is continuous monitoring that correlates the signals, spots the intrusion early, and responds before a foothold becomes a crisis.

247 days

Average time for organisations to identify *and* contain a breach

SOURCE: IBM COST OF A DATA BREACH 2026

\$4.99M

Global average total cost of a single data breach

SOURCE: IBM COST OF A DATA BREACH 2026

THE WINDOW THAT MATTERS

Intrusion
the way in

Foothold
quietly settling in

Lateral movement
spreading across systems

Impact
data theft / ransomware

↑ The sooner an attack is spotted, the smaller the damage. Closing this window — detecting and responding on the left, long before impact on the right — is the entire job of a Security Operations Centre.

WHAT CONTINUOUS MONITORING QUIETLY DOES



Sees across everything

A SIEM gathers and correlates activity from across your systems, so unusual behaviour stands out instead of hiding in the noise.



Watches around the clock

Attacks don't keep office hours. A SOC means real people monitoring day, night and weekends — not just 9 to 5.



Knows the latest tactics

Fresh threat intelligence — like the phone-spyware and software-supply-chain attacks in this issue — feeds detection so new tricks are recognised fast.



Acts, not just alerts

Alerts are triaged and investigated by analysts who step in early, turning a would-be incident into a non-event.

CLIENT ACTION OF THE WEEK

THIS WEEK'S FIX

Update every Pixel phone

Make sure all **Google Pixel** devices show a security patch level of **5 September 2026 or later** (Settings > Security & privacy > System & updates), and turn on **automatic updates** so the next fix installs itself.

GOOD HABIT

Check a key supplier's security

Pick one important supplier or software vendor and ask two questions: **how do they protect your data**, and **how would they tell you if they were breached?** This week's poisoned-software story shows how quickly a supplier's problem becomes yours.

This is the quiet, everyday work behind **DPG-Cyber's SIEM & SOC services** — the same monitoring and response that turns headlines like these into non-events for the businesses we look after. If you're ever curious how it would map to your own environment, we're always happy to talk it through, no pressure — just drop us a line at hello@dpg-cyber.com.